

BREAKWATER OPERATIONS

Comprehensive Business Plan

A DBA of Tano Holdings LLC, New Mexico
Independent AI & Operational Advisory for Northern New Mexico

Prepared by Barry Rutherford with Scout (Claude)
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1. Overview

Breakwater Operations (BW) is an independent operational and AI advisory practice founded by Barry Rutherford, a former global CEO with fifty years of operating experience, and Griffin Rutherford, an AI technical founder building Lune Synth under Coherascent Labs. BW helps nonprofits, small businesses, and mission-driven organizations in northern New Mexico cut through AI hype and make decisions they can actually execute — without selling software, taking vendor commissions, or pushing implementations that aren't warranted.

BW operates as a DBA of Tano Holdings LLC, the New Mexico umbrella entity that also holds Malestrum: The Third Phase and barryrutherford.com. Lune Synth remains a separate entity under Griffin's control. The launch market is northern New Mexico — Santa Fe, Taos, Rio Arriba, Los Alamos, and the surrounding pueblos — selected for its dense, networked nonprofit and small-business community and its existing capacity-building infrastructure BW can plug into rather than build from scratch.

This document is the first comprehensive edition of the BW business plan, consolidating market research, financial modeling, competitive analysis, and operational planning conducted through June and July 2026. It is intended as a living document, reviewed and revised as real client data replaces planning assumptions.

2. Mission Statement

Breakwater Operations exists to give nonprofits, small businesses, and mission-driven organizations in northern New Mexico — and beyond — an honest, independent voice in a moment when AI advice is cheap, plentiful, and almost always for sale.

We are a father-and-son team: a former global CEO with fifty years of operational experience, and an AI technical founder who tests what the technology can actually do. We carry no vendor relationships, no platform commissions, and no implementation business. Our only product is honest counsel.

We start with education. We follow with a diagnostic that tells you what to fix, what to leave alone, and who should do the work. We will tell you if the answer is nothing.

3. Executive Summary & Key Points

- **Market:** Northern NM TAM of ~1,500-2,000 realistic target organizations across nonprofits, small businesses, and faith-based/tribal organizations.
- **Services:** Seven service tiers from \$750 workshops to \$3,500 audits to ongoing retainers, plus a new grant/foundation research offering.
- **Year 1 revenue range:** \$55,000-\$112,500, with \$65,000 as the conservative planning case and \$100K+ as an aggressive but achievable stretch target contingent on retainer volume and workshop-to-audit conversion.
- **Client acquisition model:** Referral- and partnership-driven, not paid-media-driven. Cash customer acquisition cost is near zero — the real cost is Barry's time, not marketing spend.
- **Competitive position:** No firm in the northern NM market combines independent AI advisory, CEO-level operational credibility, and technical AI depth. Implementation shops have conflicts of interest; traditional consultants lack AI depth; nonprofit specialists lack technology depth.
- **Entity & tax:** Tano Holdings LLC, New Mexico, ~\$100-150 total formation cost, no annual state fee. GRT registration required before collecting the 8.4375% Santa Fe rate from clients, passed through on all invoices.

- **Primary risk:** Barry's personal time is the binding constraint on delivery. A Q2 2027 capacity decision point is built into the plan.
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4. Market Sectors — Deep Dive

Total Addressable Market

Segment	Realistic Target Count	Source Data
Nonprofits, greater Santa Fe	800-1,000	1,700 orgs in metro area; combined \$2B+ revenue; <50% have budgets over \$250K
Small businesses, Santa Fe County	500-800	NM has 158,844 small businesses statewide (99% of all NM businesses); SF County ~5% of state population
Faith-based & tribal orgs	150-250	23 pueblos/tribal governments in region plus congregations and dioceses
TOTAL Northern NM TAM	~1,500-2,000	

Sub-Segment Priority Order

Not all organizations in the TAM are equal first targets. Recommended sequence for outreach:

- **1.** Nonprofit executive directors and operations staff — highest AI anxiety, most open to outside advisory, referrals spread quickly within the sector.
- **2.** Small professional services firms — accountants, legal practices, architecture firms, financial advisors — high manual workflow burden and real budget for outside expertise.
- **3.** Small hospitality and tourism businesses — core of the Santa Fe economy, real operations problems, pressured by OTA dynamics and AI-native competitors.
- **4.** Tribal organizations and pueblo administrative offices — slower trust build, meaningful budgets in some cases, genuinely underserved. Best approached after a warm introduction exists.
- **5.** Faith-based organizations — real AI anxiety, typically small budgets; best treated as workshop targets rather than audit targets in Year 1.

Serviceable Available & Obtainable Market, Year 1

SAM: 150-300 organizations reachable through 2-3 institutional channel partnerships (WESST, SFCF Learning Hub, NMSBDC). SOM: roughly 10-14 workshop deliveries, 6-10 audits, 4-8 funding scans, and a handful of retainer relationships — detailed fully in the Financial Plan and Execution Calendar below.

5. Service Architecture & Pricing

Tier	Price	Target Volume Y1	Annual Revenue
AI Literacy Workshop	\$750-\$1,500	10-14/year	\$9,000-\$18,000
Industry Opportunity Scan	\$1,500	4-6/year	\$6,000-\$9,000
Operational & AI Audit	\$3,500	6-10/year	\$21,000-\$35,000
System Selection Support	\$2,000	2-4/year	\$4,000-\$8,000
Field Partner Retainer	\$500-\$750/mo	3-5 active by Q4	\$9,000-\$22,500
Funding Landscape Scan	\$1,500-\$2,500	4-8/year	\$6,000-\$20,000
TOTAL Year 1 (range)			\$55,000-\$112,500

- **Detail:** AI Literacy Workshop — half-day. Primary entry point and trust-builder. Delivered through institutional partners.

- Industry Opportunity Scan — 1-2 weeks, flat rate.
 - Operational & AI Audit — 4-6 weeks, flat rate. The primary revenue driver.
 - System Selection Support — 2-3 weeks, flat rate.
 - Field Partner Retainer — monthly, ongoing. Converts one-time engagements into durable relationships.
 - Funding Landscape Scan (NEW) — 1-2 weeks. BW reviews an organization's mission, programs, and operational priorities and maps available foundation and federal grant opportunities that fit. Research and opportunity identification only, not grant writing or submission — keeps BW in the advisory lane. Tools: Candid/Foundation Directory Online, Grants.gov, NM Philanthropy Fund, Santa Fe Community Foundation grant programs. Can bundle with the Operational Audit for nonprofit clients.
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6. Operations Plan

Delivery Model

Engagements follow: Frame, Examine, Evaluate, Prioritize, Deliver. The binding constraint on delivery is Barry's personal time. A Q2 2027 capacity decision point is built into the plan to evaluate Griffin's expanded delivery role or a referral-partner model.

Entity Structure

Tano Holdings LLC (New Mexico, single-member) is the parent entity. Breakwater Operations, Malestrum: The Third Phase, and barryrutherford.com all operate as DBAs under this umbrella — one bank account, one tax filing. Lune Synth / Coherascent Labs remains a separate entity under Griffin's control; this separation is deliberate and protects any future LS capital raise from complication.

- **Formation cost:** NM Articles of Organization: \$50 filing fee, 1-3 business days, no annual report or annual state fee.
- **GRT registration:** Must register with NM Taxation and Revenue Department before collecting GRT from clients. NAICS code 541610 (management consulting).
- **Banking:** EIN from IRS (free, same-day), then a local NM bank (Century Bank, LANB, or SFFCU preferred for relationship banking with nonprofit clients).
- **License:** Santa Fe city business license, ~\$35-50/year.

Technology & Tools Stack

Current confirmed tools: Claude Pro x2 (\$40/mo), ChatGPT Plus x2 (\$40/mo), Grok/X Premium (~\$25/mo, confirm), Ghost Pro for Malestrum (~\$29/mo, confirm BW blog sharing arrangement). None of these are currently booked as business expenses — from Tano Holdings LLC's first month of operation, all should be invoiced through the business.

- **OpenPhone:** Dedicated BW business number, \$15/mo — professional line separate from personal, voicemail transcription, call recording.
- **AIRA:** AI receptionist, \$25-50/mo — 24/7 call answering, appointment booking, bilingual support (useful in NM's Spanish-speaking market).
- **HubSpot CRM:** Free tier — contact management, pipeline tracking, follow-up reminders. Sufficient at BW's current scale.
- **Calendly:** \$12/mo — workshop and discovery call scheduling.
- **HoneyBook:** \$19/mo — proposals, contracts, invoicing, payment collection in one place. Required before the first client engagement.
- **Google Workspace:** \$12/mo — professional @breakwaterops.com email.
- **E&O Insurance:** ~\$750-1,200/year — required before any audit deliverable is handed to a client. Get 3 quotes.
- **Total:** Estimated core operational stack: ~\$225-250/month. With August outreach beta tools (Apollo, Instantly, LinkedIn Premium) added: ~\$330-400/month.

| Full itemized tech stack with all placeholder and confirmed costs is in Appendix C.

Answering & Phone Service

OpenPhone (\$15/mo) paired with AIRA AI Receptionist (\$25/mo) gives BW a complete professional phone presence for \$40/month — a dedicated NM business number with 24/7 bilingual AI call answering, appointment booking, and message-taking. This is materially cheaper and more capable than a traditional human answering service (Smith.ai hybrid runs \$292.50/month) and appropriate for BW's current call volume.

7. Strategic & Marketing Plan

Client Acquisition Channels

BW does not need paid media to acquire clients. Professional services firms typically attribute 80-90% of revenue to referrals; for 60% of consulting business owners, the first client is a referral from their own network.

- **Referral/word-of-mouth:** 50-70%+ of pipeline by Year 1 end. Every workshop and audit client becomes a referral source.
- **Institutional workshop partners:** Primary lead-gen engine. WESST, SFCF Learning Hub, NMSBDC already run rooms full of the target client. Near-zero cash cost.
- **Direct warm outreach:** 5-10 known contacts in Santa Fe nonprofit and small-business circles, approached individually.
- **Content:** Long-term credibility, feeds the referral engine over 12-18 months. Not a direct lead source in Year 1.

Content Plan — Monday Through Friday Posting Cadence

Consistent content compounds referral trust over 12-18 months. 30-45 minutes/day once sources are pre-aggregated.

- **Mon:** Industry Signal — one AI/operations story framed as 'what this means for your organization.' Opinionated, not a summary.
- **Tue:** Field Note — a real (anonymized) BW advisory observation. The primary credibility-builder. Requires Barry's direct voice.
- **Wed:** Tool or Resource — honest assessment of one specific tool or framework.
- **Thu:** Question of the Week — a real client question, answered directly. Requires Barry's direct voice.
- **Fri:** Third Phase Tie-in — bridges BW content to the Malestrum/civilizational theme, cross-posts.

Sources: MIT Technology Review, The Neuron, Axios Pro: AI, Nonprofit Tech for Good, NTEN, Stanford Social Innovation Review, Harvard Business Review AI, NPR Marketplace Tech.

Automate the feed (Feedly/Mailbrew, \$8/mo) and let Scout draft Mon/Wed/Fri from source material. Tue/Thu require Barry's direct voice and should not be automated — that voice is BW's actual differentiator.

SEO Plan

BW faces a specific namespace challenge: “breakwater” is a common term in coastal engineering, creating search collision with unrelated results. The SEO plan is built around disambiguation and hyper-local relevance rather than competing for generic terms.

- **1. Keyword strategy:** Target long-tail, location-qualified phrases where BW can realistically rank: “AI consultant Santa Fe,” “AI advisory nonprofit New Mexico,” “AI audit small business Santa Fe,” “AI literacy workshop New Mexico.” Avoid competing for generic “AI consulting” terms dominated by national firms.
- **2. Local SEO foundation:** Google Business Profile claimed and complete, consistent name/address/phone across all listings, directory listings with WESST, NMTC, and SFCF where available. Local citations matter more than generic backlinks for a geographically-bound practice.
- **3. Content as SEO:** The M-F blog cadence is the primary SEO engine — each post targets a specific long-tail query a real prospect would search. Five posts a week compounds into meaningful topical authority over 6-12 months.
- **4. Technical basics:** Site speed, mobile-friendly rendering, and LocalBusiness schema markup so search engines correctly parse BW as a local professional service, not a generic engineering term.

- **5. Backlink strategy:** Contributed bylined articles in the Santa Fe New Mexican and ABQ Business First generate high-authority backlinks that generic link-building cannot match, plus direct credibility with the exact target reader.
- **6. Partner links:** Once live, workshop partner pages (WESST, SFCF) and any press mentions should link back to breakwaterops.com — ask explicitly when the relationship is established.

SEO is a 6-12 month compounding investment, not a Year 1 lead source. Referral and institutional partnerships remain the primary Year 1 channels; SEO builds the foundation for Year 2 and beyond.

Advertising & Media Strategy

Professional services firms do not generate meaningful pipeline from newspaper or magazine display advertising. Year 1 advertising budget recommendation: \$0 on traditional print display.

- **Priority 1:** New Mexico Nonprofits Association newsletter — reaches nonprofit EDs directly. First call to make.
- **Priority 2:** NMTC (New Mexico Technology Council) — AI Peer Group and member communications reach tech-forward NM leaders. ~\$500/year membership.
- **Priority 3:** LinkedIn targeted ads — ‘executive director,’ ‘nonprofit,’ ‘small business owner’ within 50 miles of Santa Fe. \$500-\$1,000/month, far more precise than newspaper display.
- **Priority 4:** Contributed expert articles in ABQ Business First and the Santa Fe New Mexican — more credibility than paid ads at the same cost.

Reference only: Santa Fe New Mexican display ~\$500-\$2,500/ad (Pasatiempo reaches 25,282 readers); Albuquerque Journal ~\$124/column inch; ABQ Business First typically \$1,500-\$4,000+/ad; Santa Fe Reporter ~\$22/column inch. See Appendix for full detail.

8. Competitive Landscape

Northern NM Regional Snapshot

Key finding: nobody in northern NM combines independent AI advisory, CEO-level operational credibility, and technical AI depth. That gap is BW's opportunity.

- **Category 1 — AI/Automation Agencies (Low threat):** AutomateNexus, Lithium Marketing, Sundance Networks, WSI Web Enhancers — implementation shops whose revenue depends on recommending a build. They create BW's pipeline more than they threaten it (clients who had a bad implementation experience need BW next). WSI (200+ NM clients, 15+ years) is the one worth monitoring for a pivot toward independent advisory.
- **Category 2 — Traditional Management Consultants (Medium):** The Chalifour Consulting Group, Ideal State, A3 Management, Falling Colors — general strategists without AI depth. More likely referral sources than direct competitors.
- **Category 3 — Nonprofit Specialists (Partner opportunity):** Bernhardt Consulting Co., Meridian Strategies (Eduardo Martinez), Tandem Consulting — deep nonprofit relationships, no AI depth. They get AI questions they can't answer. BW should be the specialist referral — warm outreach is a Q3 2026 priority.
- **Category 4 — Free/Government Resources:** NMSBDC, WESST — the real default alternative when organizations don't hire a paid advisor. BW should be the AI specialist they refer to, not a competitor.

Full competitor-by-competitor detail, differentiation matrix, and strategic conclusions are in the standalone BW Competitive Analysis document and Appendix B of this plan.

National Competition — Overview

Large national AI consultancies and advisory arms — Deloitte AI Institute, Accenture, McKinsey QuantumBlack, BCG, IBM Consulting — exist at a completely different price point and client scale (typically six- and seven-figure engagements with Fortune 1000 or large public-sector clients). They are not realistic competitors for BW's northern NM target market in Year 1 and are deliberately out of scope for this plan's competitive analysis.

They are worth naming for two reasons: first, so the plan doesn't appear to have overlooked them; second, because the trajectory question they raise — does BW eventually scale toward a broader or more national practice, or stay deliberately boutique and regional — is a legitimate Years 3-5 strategic choice point, not a Year 1 concern. See Section 9 (Financial Plan) and the Milestones section for how that choice point is framed.

9. Financial Plan — Five-Year P&L to Net Income and EBITDA

The structure below correctly accounts for New Mexico's Gross Receipts Tax (GRT) — a privilege tax on the seller, routinely passed through to clients as a separate invoice line item, currently 8.4375% in Santa Fe — and the near-total absence of COGS and fixed assets typical of a solo advisory practice, which means EBITDA and operating income are effectively identical.

Five-Year Projection (Conservative Case)

Line Item	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
Gross Billings	\$65,000	\$110,000	\$150,000	\$180,000	\$210,000
Less: NM GRT (8.4375%)	(\$5,484)	(\$9,281)	(\$12,656)	(\$15,188)	(\$17,719)
Net Revenue	\$59,516	\$100,719	\$137,344	\$164,813	\$192,281
Less: COGS	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
Gross Profit	\$59,516	\$100,719	\$137,344	\$164,813	\$192,281
Less: Operating Expenses	(\$4,000)	(\$6,000)	(\$9,000)	(\$12,000)	(\$15,000)
EBITDA / Operating Income	\$55,516	\$94,719	\$128,344	\$152,813	\$177,281
Less: Self-Employment Tax (est.)	(\$7,800)	(\$13,000)	(\$16,500)	(\$18,000)	(\$19,500)
Less: Federal Income Tax (est.)	(\$8,000)	(\$16,000)	(\$24,000)	(\$30,000)	(\$36,000)
Less: NM State Income Tax (est.)	(\$2,500)	(\$4,500)	(\$6,200)	(\$7,500)	(\$8,800)
NET INCOME TO BARRY	\$37,216	\$61,219	\$81,644	\$97,313	\$112,981

ESTIMATE — NOT A CPA-REVIEWED FIGURE. Federal and state income tax figures assume a SEP-IRA deduction is taken each year (up to 25% of net SE income) and are directional planning estimates only. Self-employment tax uses the 15.3% rate on 92.35% of net SE income up to the annual Social Security wage base; figures approximate the effect of that cap in later years. A Santa Fe CPA should review this table before it is used for any tax planning or filing decision. Operating expenses scale to reflect a growing tech stack, potential contractor/Giffin compensation for BW technical work, and increased marketing spend in later years.

Revenue Growth Assumptions

- **Year 1:** Conservative case: \$55,000-\$65,000, driven by 10-14 workshops, 6-10 audits, 3-5 retainers, and the new grant scan tier.
- **Year 2:** \$90,000-\$130,000, driven by compounding referrals, inbound content, and a maturing retainer base.
- **Year 3:** ~\$150,000, assuming the referral flywheel is fully established and a second institutional partnership (NMSBDC) is active.
- **Year 4:** ~\$180,000, contingent on the Q2 2027 capacity decision resolving in favor of expanded delivery capacity (Griffin's expanded role or a referral-partner/associate model).
- **Year 5:** ~\$210,000, or a deliberate strategic pivot toward a boutique-scale plateau if that is the preferred Year 3-5 choice — see Section 8's national competition framing.

10. Execution Calendar

Immediate Action Items — July 2026

- **Week 1:** Form Tano Holdings LLC (Articles of Organization, \$50 filing) and register for NM GRT simultaneously.
- **Week 1-2:** Open Tano Holdings LLC business bank account once EIN is issued. Fix remaining 'neuro-symbolic' language on breakwaterops.com and barryrutherford.com.
- **Week 2-3:** Set up OpenPhone + AIRA, HubSpot Free, Calendly, HoneyBook, Google Workspace email. Get 3 E&O insurance quotes.
- **Week 3-4:** LinkedIn profile reboot live. Begin M-F content cadence. Build 50-target Apollo.io list for August beta.

Year 1 Monthly Milestones

- **Q3 2026 (Jul-Sep):** Positioning finalized, first 2 workshops delivered through a channel partnership, blog cadence begins, LinkedIn reboot live. 50-target outreach beta launches first week of August.
 - **Q4 2026 (Oct-Dec):** 2-3 additional workshops, first 1-2 audits completed, first Field Partner retainer signed. Cumulative target: \$15,000-\$25,000.
 - **Q1 2027:** Review actual workshop-to-audit conversion vs. planning assumption. Decide on NMSBDC partnership. First funding scan delivered.
 - **Q2 2027:** Capacity decision point — Barry's time vs. Griffin's expanded role vs. referral-partner model. Evaluate Sam Hotchkiss/Russell ecosystem partnership readiness.
 - **Year 2:** \$90,000-\$130,000 revenue, driven by inbound referrals and repeat business.
 - **Years 3-5:** Strategic choice point: remain northern-NM boutique, formalize an associate/referral network to multiply capacity, or begin deliberate regional expansion.
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11. Trusted Partner Network (New — From Griffin's Austin Trip)

During the late-June Austin trip, Griffin attended four networking events, gave 25+ Lune Synth demos, and identified several individuals whose services complement BW's advisory work. This section formalizes those relationships as BW's Trusted Partner Network — a curated referral list, not a paid implementation arm.

GOVERNING PRINCIPLE: BW refers, discloses, and does not take a commission on these relationships. The value BW provides is curation — vetted introductions, not a sales channel. This preserves the 'no vendor relationships, no commissions' positioning that is BW's core differentiator. If any relationship later involves a referral fee, it must be explicitly disclosed to the client in writing before any engagement.

Candidates Identified, By Fit

- **Strong fit:** A contact who helps small business owners and founders with financial reporting and compliance. Directly complementary to BW's small-business target segment. Priority: build this relationship first.
- **Strong fit:** A startup tracking, monitoring, and providing insights on AI token/usage costs. Directly relevant once a BW client adopts AI tools and needs ongoing cost management — a real, recurring pain point for budget-constrained nonprofits.
- **Situational fit:** An Emmy-nominated videography and marketing content firm. Not a Year 1 BW client need, but a strong resource for clients further along, and separately relevant to Malestrum's production quality.
- **Situational fit:** A firm specializing in AI-driven tax auditing and compliance. Likely more relevant once BW serves larger nonprofit clients with complex 990 filings — a Year 2 conversation.
- **Weak fit for BW:** Oil and gas compliance AI contacts. Interesting technology but geographically mismatched — NM oil and gas activity concentrates in the Permian Basin, southeast NM, outside BW's northern NM target market. Keep the contact, not a Year 1 priority.

Follow-Up Protocol

- **Immediate:** Personalized follow-up (photo + specific one-line reference to the actual conversation, not a template) to every Austin contact within 48-72 hours of the trip.
 - **This week:** For the strong-fit contacts, propose a specific 20-minute call to understand what they offer and how a no-commission referral relationship would work — not a vague 'let's stay in touch.'
 - **Ongoing:** Every contact logged in HubSpot CRM, tagged by category (implementation partner / content partner / financial-compliance partner), with last-contact date and next action — without this, warm contacts go cold within about three weeks.
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12. Risks & Open Questions

- **1. Relationship duration:** The Field Partner retainer is the proposed mechanism for extending the relationship past a one-time audit — unproven in Year 1.
 - **2. Capacity ceiling:** Barry's personal time is the delivery constraint; the Q2 2027 decision point addresses this directly.
 - **3. Conversion assumptions:** The workshop-to-audit conversion rate is a planning estimate, not observed data — first real signal arrives from the August beta.
 - **4. Channel dependency:** Year 1 success leans on securing at least one institutional partnership (WESST or SFCF).
 - **5. Namespace/discoverability:** “Breakwater” has real search collision with unrelated coastal engineering content — addressed in the SEO plan via hyper-local, disambiguated keyword targeting.
 - **6. Tax estimates unverified:** The GRT rate, income tax estimates, and SE tax figures in Section 9 require a Santa Fe CPA's review before being relied upon.
 - **7. Griffin's capacity is a shared constraint:** Griffin's time is shared across LS, BW, MS, and BR — growth in any one property draws on the same finite technical capacity.
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Appendix A: Partner & Professional Organizations

Northern NM Regional

Organization	What They Are / Contact
WESST(Women's Economic Self-Sufficiency Team)	Statewide nonprofit business development organization, founded 1988. Santa Fe office at the Santa Fe Business Incubator, 3900 Paseo del Sol, Suite 322A, Santa Fe, NM 87507. Phone: (505) 474-6556. First consultation free. Primary workshop partnership target.
SFBI(Santa Fe Business Incubator)	Physical hub at 3900 Paseo del Sol hosting WESST and other partner organizations. Venue and connector, not a direct lead source.
SFCF Learning Hub(Santa Fe Community Foundation)	Educational programming for the regional nonprofit sector. Strong fit for an AI literacy workshop pitch.
NMSBDC(New Mexico Small Business Development Center)	Statewide network of 19 centers, free one-on-one business advising. Secondary partnership target, evaluated by Q1 2027.
NMTC(New Mexico Technology Council)	Albuquerque-based statewide tech association, founded 2000. Runs the annual Tech Summit (700+ attendees) and an active AI Peer Group. P.O. Box 4125, Albuquerque, NM 87196. (505) 847-6840. Estimated ~\$500/year membership — confirm directly. Strongest regional fit for BW's AI-specific positioning.

National

Organization	What They Are / Contact
NTEN(Nonprofit Technology Network)	The nonprofit sector's dedicated technology association. MEMBERSHIP IS FREE. Puts BW directly in front of nonprofit technology decision-makers nationally — the exact audience BW serves. Runs the annual Nonprofit Technology Conference (NTC, 130+ sessions, thousands of attendees) with strong AI-specific programming, quarterly member calls (a recent one focused specifically on AI governance in practice), and a free 'AI for Nonprofits' cohort run in active partnership with Anthropic. P.O. Box 86308, Portland, OR 97286. No cost, no reason not to join immediately.

EDUCAUSE (major higher-ed AI/technology association) and AAAI (international AI research society) were also researched. Both are legitimate national/international bodies, but EDUCAUSE membership is institutional and priced for colleges and universities — a better fit for Lune Synth if Griffin pursues higher-ed or K-12 institutional sales than for BW directly — and AAAI is oriented toward AI researchers and academics rather than advisory practices. Neither is recommended as a Year 1 BW priority.

Appendix B: National & Legacy Organizations — Honest Assessment

Organization	Assessment
Santa Fe Chamber of Commerce	General local visibility, not targeted access to BW's actual buyer. Typical dues ~\$250-450/year. Lower priority than WESST or NMTC given BW's referral-driven model.
BBB Accreditation	A consumer-trust badge (~\$400-700/year), most valuable for businesses selling directly to price/trust-comparing consumers. BW's referral-driven pipeline already carries that trust. Recommend skipping.
IMC USA(Institute of Management Consultants)	Sole U.S. certifying body for management consultants (CMC credential, recognized in 46 countries). Membership ~\$400-600/year. Certification requires evidence of track record — a Year 2 consideration once 6+ engagements are on the books, not a Year 1 priority.

Appendix C: Complete Tech Stack & Costs

Current, recommended, and optional tools with monthly/annual costs. Yellow-flagged items are placeholders requiring confirmation.

Tool	Monthly	Annual	Notes
Claude Pro x2	\$40	\$480	Primary strategy/writing/code AI. Book as Tano Holdings expense.
ChatGPT Plus x2	\$40	\$480	Logistics, image generation, MS comic strip.
Grok (X Premium)	~\$25	~\$300	PLACEHOLDER — confirm actual cost.
Ghost Pro (Malestrum)	~\$29	~\$348	PLACEHOLDER — confirm whether BW blog shares this account.
OpenPhone	\$15	\$180	Dedicated BW business number.
AIRA AI Receptionist	\$25	\$300	24/7 bilingual call answering.
HubSpot CRM	\$0	\$0	Free tier sufficient at current scale.
Calendly	\$12	\$144	Scheduling.
HoneyBook	\$19	\$228	Proposals, contracts, invoicing.
Google Workspace	\$12	\$144	Professional email.
E&O Insurance	~\$80	~\$950	Required before first audit delivered. Get 3 quotes.
Apollo.io (beta)	\$0	\$0	Free tier for list-building.
Instantly.ai (beta)	\$37	\$444	Outreach sequencing, Aug-Sep only.
LinkedIn Premium (beta)	\$40	\$480	Sales Navigator, starts 2 weeks after LinkedIn reboot.
ESTIMATED CORE MONTHLY TOTAL	~\$225-250	~\$2,700-3,000	Excludes beta outreach tools.

Appendix D: Decisions Needed

#	Decision	Recommendation / Status
1	Tano Holdings LLC as umbrella entity	AGREED. tano.holdings domain purchased. Filing in progress.
2	NM GRT pass-through vs. absorbed	RECOMMENDED: pass-through, itemized on invoices at 8.4375%.
3	Answering service selection	RECOMMENDED: OpenPhone + AIRA, \$40/mo combined.
4	CRM/proposal/e-signature tooling	RECOMMENDED: HubSpot Free + HoneyBook. Needed before first client.
5	SEP-IRA setup timing	Must establish by Dec 31, Year 1 for the tax deduction. Assign to NM CPA.
6	E&O insurance vendor	Get 3 quotes before first audit is delivered.
7	October Austin trip: yes/no	~\$7,500. Ecosystem Year 1 net: \$32,017 without it, \$24,517 with it. Strategic, not financial, decision.
8	Trusted Partner Network commission policy	RECOMMENDED: no commission, full disclosure if that ever changes. See Section 11.

Appendix E: Key Issues to Consider

#	Issue	Why It Matters
1	Griffin's capacity is shared across LS, BW, BR, MS	The BW stretch target and the LS benchmark milestone both require Griffin in the same window. Needs explicit weekly hours allocation, reviewed monthly.
2	'Neuro-symbolic' language still live in places	Flagged multiple times. Should not survive past this week.
3	No CRM/proposal/e-signature workflow yet exists	Needs to be in place before the first paying client, not scrambled together after a yes.
4	AI tooling spend currently untracked	~\$150-200/mo combined across Claude/ChatGPT/Grok, none currently booked as a business expense.
5	Barry's BR time is protected in the plan but not yet in the calendar	Protection only holds if it's scheduled — specific calendar blocks, not 'whatever's left.'

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